is used to accumulate and transact information for reference purposes. These forms serve as a storehouse of information. Since the office work is largely paper work, the form used should be designed so as furnish the required information in an appropriate manner. It is the duty of the office to design the forms that can be used in various departments.

4. **Purchasing and Supply of Office Stationery:** Majority of office work are paper work. Consequently adequate supply of office stationery of suitable quality is of prime importance for the systematic and efficient performance of office work. It is the task of office to look after the standardisation, selection, and purchase of office stationery and its distribution to different departments.

5. **Selection and Purchase of Office Furniture, Equipment and Machines:** The office has to select and purchase the right type of furniture, equipment and machines in right quantities, so that office work can be carried out according to the planned system and routine without any interruptions and must also ensure their fullest utilisation in the organisation.

6. **Public Relations Functions:** An office has not only maintained relations with the other departments, it also needs to maintain a good dealings with the outside world such as suppliers, customers, bankers, government departments and the public at large. Maintaining good relations with these stakeholders increases the reputation and goodwill of the company.

7. **Retention of the Records:** Records are those documents which serves as objective evidence of activities performed, events occurred, results achieved, or statements made. They are created /received by an organization in routine transaction of its business or in pursuance of its legal obligations. Office retains records such as correspondence, invoices, orders, financial and cost records, and minutes etc., for future reference.

8. **Safeguarding Assets:** It is one of the functions of office to safeguard the assets of the organisation, such as immovable assets like buildings, plants, machinery, office equipments, lighting and air conditioning equipments, and movable assets like furniture, office machinery, title deeds, records and documents, or cash, etc., against loss or damages from unforeseen conditions.

9. **Controlling office Costs:** With the adoption of scientific methods in office management, a modern office discharges the function of controlling office costs through

   (a) Mechanization of the office.

   (b) Adopting time and labour saving devices in the office.

   (c) Using better forms.

   (d) Analyzing the existing office routines and adopting improved ones.

OSS_EM_Chapter_1.indd 6 04-03-2019 09:51:49